

Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Leader · Leeds, United Kingdom · British Citizen

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Professional Summary

Software Engineering Leader with 20+ years in technology and 9 years of progressive leadership — 4 of them line-managing engineers — across regulated industries — financial services, utilities, energy, global retail, and public sector technology. Proven track record of building and retaining high-performing remote teams, navigating organisational design through complex restructurings, and architecting critical platform services. I treat engineering as a business lever—contributing to CapEx/OpEx planning and ensuring technical investments map directly to business outcomes. The pattern across those years is consistent: I build the thing that isn't there — a team where there was no department, documentation from zero, structure where there was firefighting, a career where there was no industry to offer one. While my technical depth across frontend and platform architecture establishes credibility, my true strength lies in designing the conditions where engineers do their best work.

Core Competencies

- **Engineering Leadership & People Development:** Proven track record of building, mentoring, and retaining high-performing remote teams (100% retention rate) while driving 3 promotions through evidence-based cases informed by DORA metrics. Measurement-led: using DORA (via DX), team health tracking, and Peakon Heartbeat surveys to ensure performance is visible, sustainable, and connected to career progression.
- **Organisational Design & Change Management:** Experienced in navigating complex restructurings, building teams from scratch, and shaping team structures that align engineering capability with business outcomes. Have built the same team twice from zero.
- **Platform & Infrastructure Strategy:** Architecting and managing critical platform services and dependencies with a focus on SLAs, SLIs, and operational excellence for 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design Systems Leadership:** End-to-end experience building and managing Design Systems — from open-source implementation (Pulsar at Jadu) to leading a dedicated Design Systems team at scale, enabling consistent, high-velocity delivery across product and engineering.
- **Commercial Engineering & Business Acumen:** Treating engineering as a business lever, not a cost centre. Managing a vendor portfolio exceeding £200k a year across six platform services, with active contribution to CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor ROI evaluation, and ensuring every technical investment maps to a business outcome.
- **Regulated Industry Experience:** Proven delivery across multiple regulated sectors — financial services (Leeds Building Society), multi-service utilities including energy (Utility Warehouse), and public sector technology (Jadu / Local Authorities). Understanding of compliance-driven environments, data governance, and operating platforms where reliability has regulatory consequences.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Company: Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

Dates: Jul 2023 - Present

Location: United Kingdom · Remote

Employment Type: Full-time

Responsibilities:

- **Team Leadership, Retention & Development:** Grew to 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs — web/CMS/tracking, mobile, and design systems — comprising six direct reports plus a Design Systems Lead and a Staff Engineer whose day-to-day management and 1:1s I held on a dotted line, alongside a Product Manager. Sustained a 100% retention rate through three reorganisations that moved the team across three departments in 25 months — Platforms (May 2023), Customer Experience (Jul 2024), Partner (Jun 2025) — the last reducing it to a specialist core. Every reduction was organisational; zero voluntary attrition. Drove 3 promotions through evidence-based cases, advocating across organisational boundaries, and mentored engineers who moved into Engineering Manager roles both internally and externally.
- **Performance Measurement & Team Health:** Early adopter of DORA metrics — progressed from manual team health tracking and custom EM dashboards to the organisation-wide DX platform. Delivery data (deployment frequency, lead time, change failure rate, MTTR) directly informs promotion cases and bonus decisions, complemented by monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys translated into concrete actions within the team's sphere of influence.
- **Org Design & Strategic Influence:** During restructurings, took on unguided responsibility for scoping and executing team migrations between pillars — independently mapping scope, chasing stakeholder alignment, and building consensus from scratch. When the Customer Experience move brought a mobile backlog into the team's remit, negotiated the inbound transfer of a Senior Engineer with mobile expertise, matching capability to scope rather than absorbing the work unprepared. Challenged and reversed structural decisions that would have eliminated the Design Systems team, preserving the critical capability that enabled the 2025 company-wide rebrand.
- **Documentation, Knowledge Culture & Upskilling:** Authored over 100 articles of technical documentation — from process guides to architecture decisions — making the team the most thoroughly documented at UW. Inherited an undocumented legacy CMS and conducted systematic discovery ("Archeology") to map what existed before building the culture from scratch. Identified capability gaps (e.g. Kubernetes), closed them through self-directed learning, then trained the team and pushed engineers to own RFCs and cross-team knowledge-sharing.
- **Rebranding Programme (Oct 2025 – Apr 2026; 522 pages shipped):** Delivered UW's company-wide brand refresh across the full uw.co.uk estate — the primary digital entry point for customers, partners, and the subscriber account system, and the platform where all A/B tests and business tracking metrics run. Our delivery was the critical path: no other team's rebranding work could go live until the main website shipped. Authored automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of manual hours.
- **Platform Reliability & Analytics Ownership:** Operated uw.co.uk against a 99.99% SLO with a single incident in the current year — resolved within hours, zero downtime otherwise — and <3s page load times on critical-path pages. Managing a digital estate of 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, and 1,300+ shortlinks and redirects. Supported 8 content teams (33 direct users) and 15+ engineering teams as platform dependencies. Owns the full platform analytics and compliance stack — Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust — six platform services monitored via Kubernetes, Sentry, Prometheus, Pingdom, and Cloudflare.
- **Design Systems (Hearth) — 20 teams, company-wide adoption:** Led adoption of the Hearth Design System across 20 engineering and product teams (15 full adoption, 5 partial). Consolidating component work at the Design System level eliminated thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort — savings at rebrand scale reaching into the hundreds of thousands. Contributed to the company's R&D tax credit claims by translating Design Systems work into audit-ready documentation for external advisors.

- **CMS Transformation (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Led the end-to-end replacement of an effectively abandoned legacy CMS (no SLA, no SSO, dead tech stack). Conducted rigorous 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, and selected Contentful — a six-figure annual enterprise contract, chosen for the enterprise-grade SLAs and support most vendors couldn't offer. Executed a zero-disruption dual-serve migration; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained content scheduling, structured content models, and eliminated duplication — removing major technical debt.
- **Adaptability Under Constraints (2025–Present):** Following restructurings that reduced the team to 2 engineers, stepped across role boundaries — absorbing Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside Engineering Management — to sustain delivery across 6 platform services with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate, without losing a single engineer or breaching the platform SLO.

Lead Software Engineer

Company: Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance) **Dates:** May 2022 - Jul 2023 (1 yr 3 mos)

Location: United Kingdom · Remote

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Joined a standalone team with no formal department, no established processes, and no documentation — built to leverage my cross-functional expertise in engineering, UX, and Agile delivery.

- **Team Building from Zero:** Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing — no department, no precedent. Started as three — myself, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer — and held that shape for a full year, delivering with a single engineer before headcount arrived. Line-managed that engineer from May 2022: with no Head of Engineering in post and my own manager delegating heavily, people responsibility sat with me from the start — 14 months before the title caught up. Grew to five in May 2023 with two external hires, and promoted the founding Associate to Software Engineer a month later. The team was renamed Content Capability (Nov 2022) and moved into the Platforms department (May 2023) — the first of three reorganisations it would outlast, a mark of its embedded value to the business.
- **Engineering Rigour from Scratch:** Established a fully operational Scrum environment with structured backlog, measurable velocity, and predictable delivery — filling Product Manager gaps when needed and transforming a nascent capability into a reliable engineering team. Conducted systematic discovery ("Archeology") on the legacy Apostrophe CMS, authored the team's foundational documentation, and set the standard that would grow into 100+ articles of process and technical documentation.
- **CMS Strategy & Decision:** Led the evaluation process that resulted in UW's adoption of Contentful as its enterprise CMS. Presented findings and audit trail to leadership; recommendation accepted and implemented.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

Company: IMA-HOME

Dates: Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 (2 yrs 4 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom

Employment Type: Full-time, Hybrid

Description: Operated as a dual-role technical leader for global brands (Adidas, MARS). Alongside architecting frontend solutions, I formally took on Scrum Master responsibilities to elevate the organisation's delivery standards and project predictability.

Agile Transformation: Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery. Result: measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos — improving delivery health and client confidence across the board.

Global Design Systems (Royal Canin / MARS): Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence — a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support. Served traffic in the millions.

Projects: Adidas, MARS, Gregg Wallace, Leeds Rhinos, Royal Canin

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Company: Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)

Dates: Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 (1 yr 4 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society — a highly regulated financial services environment — while actively mentoring engineering teams to elevate code quality and UX standards.

Agile Pioneer: Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time, shifting a high-bureaucracy, low-velocity organisation from ad-hoc output to sprint-based iterative delivery with measurable velocity. Acted as the primary driver for Agile adoption across the department throughout my tenure.

Leadership in Crisis — Digital Transformation (Interim Scrum Master, Jun–Oct 2019): Formally appointed to stabilise delivery and lead the Digital Transformation programme — working alongside external consultants and cross-functional teams to move a firefighting culture into structured, iterative feature development with regular delivery cadences.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Company: Jadu

Dates: Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 (1 yr 10 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Designed UIs and developed new features with a strict focus on user experience, accessibility, and W3C standards for an award-winning custom CMS used by Local Authorities, Higher Education, and third-sector organisations.

Design Systems: Co-created and maintained **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is the foundation of my Design Systems specialism, combining component architecture, accessibility, and cross-team enablement.

Agile Delivery: Gained foundational, hands-on Agile leadership experience through a rotating Scrum Master model, facilitating sprint planning, daily standups, and embedding the core principles of the Agile manifesto into the team's workflow.

UX Research & End-to-End Feature Ownership: Owned the full feature lifecycle for the CMS product — conducting regular on-site contextual inquiry at client organisations (Wyre Council, Rotherham Council, Greater Manchester Combined Authority, City of York Council, University of Leeds), distilling field research into reports that shaped the product roadmap, and iterating from mockups through usability testing to production release. Operated as one of three product-area leads (CMS, Forms, CRM), each independently responsible for their domain.

Projects: Award-winning custom CMS for large-scale public sector institutions — Open source Interface Design System ([Pulsar](#))

Early Career, Teaching & Consulting

Dates: Oct 2005 - Dec 2016 (11 years)

Provincial northern Greece — Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry to join and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway — client by client — and led long before anyone gave me a title for it:

- **Web Development & Freelancing (2005–2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally — from local non-profits and bands to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed end-to-end client relationships, established professional billing structures (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed development teams. Platforms: WordPress, Drupal, custom HTML/CSS.
- **Community & Civic Technology (2008–2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national open-source conference), and managed the digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, an EVS programme, and the MSG Panserraikos sports club. This civic technology portfolio predates and directly informs my later UK community work (GDG Leeds, IxDF Leeds, NUX).
- **Teaching & Mentorship (2006–2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional (CTP) qualification and spent a year teaching ECDL to adult learners. Privately tutored a student in algorithmic logic, C, and hardware (Arduino/Raspberry Pi) — that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and now works as an engineer at Sophos.
- **UK Agency Work (2015–2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Delivered frontend engineering for agencies — building responsive e-commerce for global fashion and retail brands (Vivienne Westwood) and driving performance optimisation.

Education

Institution: International University of Greece - Serres Campus

Degree: BSc Informatics Engineering (2007–2012) — strong grades in software engineering, programming, and databases. Left without the certificate when the Greek economic crisis hit; the freelance business I was already running became the career.

Professional Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023

Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list — Scrum, UX, FinTech, analytics, cloud, accessibility, and more — available on the [Credentials](#) page.

Community & Leadership

Mentor, WRK digital (Feb 2023–Present): Mentored engineers who progressed into Engineering Manager roles (both within UW and externally). Peer mentoring network spanning Engineering Managers, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code (*Aug 2023–Jan 2024*): Supported early-career engineers entering the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds (*Jan 2019–Mar 2020*): Revived an inactive GDG chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and technical meetups.